

Amachu remembers, “He never took much credit on mailing lists but he expressed himself in a way that others could learn from his successes as well as failures. The lists to which he belonged will definitely miss him.”

Kenneth: The believer

Kenneth Gonsalves was a man of strong beliefs. He lived his life with conviction regarding open source technology and he passed on his beliefs to his family as well. Amita Gonsalves, the elder daughter of the Gonsalves couple, said, “Dad introduced all of us to open source technology to the extent that we did not know there actually was a Windows world that existed. I remember the first time I was exposed to Windows in my school; I was rather confused as to why it was so different from what I did at home. He made my mom, my sister and I work only on open source technology.”

Kenneth was ‘unapproachable’ via the normal means of communication. You had to email him to get a quick reply! Amita

remembers, “For all the issues that I had to discuss with Dad, ranging from technology to anything in life, email was the easiest way. I remember I wanted to ask him something and we were at the same place. I tried calling him but he didn’t respond. I then mailed him to check if he is around and immediately got my reply. That was the technology side of my Dad.”

Amita recalls the day Gonsalves left this world. She says, “I called up Dad in the morning before going for work and he complained about some uneasiness. He had to deliver a talk at one of the colleges that day, which he had postponed. I told him to take some rest and said that I would call him later. That ‘later’ never came. I got the news of his leaving us at around 1.30 pm on August 3.” 

By: Diksha P Gupta

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FOSS IS

Kenneth Gonsalves was a regular contributor to *LINUX ForYou* magazine. The magazine cherishes his contribution for spreading the word of open source through the platform. Here are a few extracts of his writing under the section ‘FOSS IS FUN’.

1. The open source world highly values the sanctity of copyright, and frowns on plagiarism and “piracy” of all kinds. At the same time, the idea of open source does not mean throwing the source code into the public domain for all and sundry to use in any manner that they want. So there are two contradictory targets here. The authors of the code want to ensure that the largest number of people are able to benefit from their code in the fullest manner possible. Yet, at the same time, they are not happy with people misusing their code to make unfair profits from it...

2. Unfortunately, a lot of people and companies are attempting to cash in on the popularity of open source by subverting open source licenses and offering bogus open source products. In the long run, these bogus products wind up causing great harm to the open source movement by raising false expectations and not fulfilling them. The most common example is to have two versions of the software—a free “community” edition and a proprietary paid version. The free version has limited features and functionality. The paid-for version has all the bells and whistles. But all the advertising and hype is about the paid version...

3. In any forum that talks about programming, a frequent topic is, “What is the best IDE for the language/framework under discussion?” This often leads to lengthy flame wars, because programmers are passionate about the tools they choose to work with. And there are a very large number of tools available—right from simple text editors like KWrite to behemoths like Emacs. What do people mean when they talk about an IDE? They usually mean one tool that helps automate the development and deployment of an application. Let us look at what it takes to develop and deploy a Web application...

4. There are a plethora of free/open source databases around—from the good old Berkeley DB, PostgreSQL, to the newer NoSQL DBs like MongoDB, to mention a few. Most of these have easy-to-use GUI interfaces too. As a result, the threshold to becoming a “database administrator” has become very low, and the quality of the average database is abysmal. People who do not know the A or B of database design are happily doing mission-critical stuff. SQL injection was discovered in the last century, and the prevention is well known—but guess which is still one of the most popular ways of cracking websites?...